

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Discord Server Admin Guide

For community hosts managing their own tournament

You received a tournament URL and admin password from the platform organiser. This guide walks you through every step of running your community's tournament.

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1. What You Have Access To

The platform organiser has created a tournament specifically for your community. You have been given:

Item	What It Is
Tournament URL	The web address for your community's tournament. Share this with your players.
Admin Password	Your private password to access the admin panel for your tournament only.
Isolated Tournament	Your players, brackets, and data are completely separate from all other communities.

What you control:

- 1 Season name, dates, and structure
- 2 ELO division names and ranges
- 3 Prize fee PER DIVISION — make some free, others paid
- 4 Prize splits per division (1st/2nd/3rd place %)
- 5 Time windows for scheduling matches
- 6 Placement match settings (map, resources, speed)
- 7 Your PayPal email (required before launch)
- 8 Confirming player payments as Received
- 9 Player bans and reports

What the platform organiser controls:

- 1 Platform hosting and technical upkeep
- 2 Platform admin fee amount (you see it as read-only)
- 3 Your kickback % (the bonus they share back with you)

4 Creating and deleting tournaments

2. Logging Into Your Admin Panel

- 1 Open your tournament URL in a browser.
- 2 Click **Admin** in the navigation bar at the top.
- 3 Enter your admin password and click Unlock (or press Enter).
- 4 When finished, click **Lock Admin** to close your session.

First time logging in? Change your password immediately. Admin → Passwords → Change Admin Password.

3. First-Time Setup Checklist

Step	Where	Done?
Change admin password	Admin → Passwords	☐
Set season name	Admin → Season	☐
Add your PayPal email	Admin → Season	☐
Click Save Season Settings	Admin → Season	☐
Configure ELO divisions	Admin → Tiers	☐
Set a prize fee per division	Admin → Tiers	☐
Set prize splits per division	Admin → Tiers	☐
Click Save Divisions	Admin → Tiers	☐
Set time windows, click Save	Admin → Time Windows	☐
Set placement settings, click Save	Admin → Placement	☐
Post Discord announcement	Discord tab	☐
Open registration	Admin → Season	☐

4. Understanding the Save Button System

Settings pages with multiple fields (Season, Time Windows, Placement, Tiers) now use an **explicit Save button** instead of saving every keystroke automatically.

How it works:

- 1 Type or change anything on the page — nothing is saved yet, only held in a local draft.
- 2 A bar appears at the bottom of the panel showing the current state.
- 3 '● **Unsaved changes**' in gold means you've made edits that aren't saved yet.
- 4 '✓ **All changes saved**' in grey means everything matches what's actually stored.
- 5 Click the ■ **Save** button to commit your changes — you'll see a confirmation toast (e.g. 'Season settings saved!').

Why this matters: If you edit a field and refresh or navigate away WITHOUT clicking Save, your edit is lost (the saved data on the server never changed). Always look for the gold '● Unsaved changes' indicator and click Save before leaving a settings page.

Switching between admin tabs (e.g. Season → Tiers → back to Season) keeps your unsaved draft intact, so you won't lose work just by browsing around. The draft only resets if you switch to viewing a different tournament entirely.

Action buttons like **Open Registration**, **Confirm Received**, **Ban Player**, etc. are NOT affected by this — those are one-click actions that take effect immediately, same as before.

5. Configuring Season Settings

Go to **Admin** → **Season**.

First — add your PayPal email. Required before you can open any paid division bracket. Players send your prize fee share directly to this address.

Setting	What to Enter	Tip
Season Name	e.g. Summer 2025 or NA Kings S1	Shown on your tournament home page
Placement Games	Default: 5	More games = more accurate ELO
Swiss Rounds	Default: 7	7 is correct for 100–200 players
Top N Playoff	Default: 8 (Top 8)	Can be 4, 8, or 16
Platform Admin Fee	Read-only — set by the platform organiser	Contact them to request a change
Default Prize Fee	Starting value for NEW divisions only	Each existing division has its own — see Tiers

Click **Save Season Settings** when done.

6. Per-Division Prize Fees & Splits

Go to **Admin** → **Tiers**. Each division is a separate ELO bracket with its own Swiss tournament, champion, **and its own prize fee**.

This is different from older versions of the app: there is no single tournament-wide prize fee anymore. You set the fee separately for each division — meaning you can make entry-level divisions free to attract new players while charging for your most competitive division.

Division	ELO Range	Example Prize Fee
Bronze	0 – 499	\$0 — Free!
Silver	500 – 799	\$5
Gold	800 – 1099	\$5
Diamond	1100 and up	\$10

To set a division's prize fee:

- 1 Find the division card in Admin → Tiers.
- 2 In the 'Prize Fee for [Division] (\$, 0 = free)' field, type the amount.
- 3 The 'Total Entry' badge updates live to show admin fee + this division's prize fee.

Prize splits per division:

Each division card also has ■ 1st, ■ 2nd, and ■ 3rd place percentage fields (default 60/25/15). These should total 100%. As you type, the app shows the live dollar amount for each place based on confirmed payments so far in that specific division.

Live Prize Pool shown on each division card updates automatically — every time a player in that division has their payment confirmed as Received, the pool grows by that division's prize fee amount.

Remember to click ■ **Save Divisions** after editing — your changes (including new/removed divisions) are not committed until you do.

Set your tier ranges and prize fees BEFORE opening registration — players are classified into tiers based on ELO, so your ranges need to be final before placement games begin.

7. Setting Time Windows

Go to **Admin** → **Time Windows**. Time windows tell the agent which days and hours to schedule placement matches. All times are UTC.

Click **+ Add Time Window** to add a window. Each has a Day, Start Hour, End Hour, and Label.

Your Community		Example Windows to Add
North American players		Saturday 18:00–23:00 UTC and Sunday 18:00–23:00 UTC
European players		Saturday 13:00–21:00 UTC and Sunday 13:00–21:00 UTC
Mixed US + Europe		Saturday 16:00–21:00 UTC (works for both regions)
No preference		Leave empty — matches spread in 2-hour gaps

Click **■ Save Time Windows** after adding, editing, or removing any window.

8. Setting Placement Match Rules

Go to **Admin** → **Placement**. These settings apply to all ELO classification games.

Setting	Default	Notes
Map	Random Map	Standard for placement — fair for all civs
Resources	Standard	Change to High if your community prefers
Game Speed	Normal	Most players use Normal or Fast
Spectator Delay	10 minutes	Cannot go below 10 min
Recording Required	Yes	Strongly recommended for disputes

Click **Save Placement Settings** when done.

9. Opening Registration — Announcing to Your Server

Go to **Admin** → **Season** → **Open Registration**. Then announce to your Discord server.

Go to the **Discord** tab. Click **Copy** under the Tournament Announcement. Paste it into your server's announcement channel.

What players need to do:

- 1 Click the tournament URL and click Register.
- 2 Complete their 5 free placement games — no payment needed yet.
- 3 Once classified, pay their division's specific entry fee via PayPal.
- 4 Wait for you to mark their payment as Received.

Tell players: Registration is free. Placement games are free. The entry fee only applies when entering the division bracket, and varies by division.

10. Closing Registration & Generating the Schedule

When registration is over, go to **Admin** → **Season** and click **Close & Generate Schedule**.

The agent will **immediately and automatically**:

- 1 Pair every player with 5 placement opponents (ELO-balanced, no rematches).
- 2 Assign time slots from your saved time windows, spread evenly.
- 3 Generate a unique lobby name and password for every match.
- 4 Show every player their schedule the next time they log in.

This is your most important step. After this, the tournament runs itself.

11. Verifying Payments

Go to **Admin** → **Payments**. Every classified player in a paid division appears here with their division shown and their specific owed amount.

- 1 When a player sends you their prize fee payment: click **Confirm Received** next to their name.
- 2 A green checkmark appears when confirmed.
- 3 Only Received players in paid divisions count toward bracket eligibility — free divisions never block on payment.

Payment tip: Ask players to send PayPal payments with their Discord name and tournament code in the note (the app pre-fills this automatically when they click Pay via PayPal in their portal).

12. Opening Division Brackets

Once enough players have completed placement games, go to **Admin** → **Season** and click **Open Division Brackets**.

The agent opens all qualifying divisions simultaneously. Each division checks its OWN fee requirement — free divisions open with any 2+ classified players; paid divisions require those players to show Received payment status.

13. Locking Settings & Starting Swiss

- 1 Go to the **Divisions** tab. View vote tallies for Map, Resources, Speed per division.
- 2 Click **Lock Settings** when satisfied.
- 3 Click **Start Swiss R1**, or use Admin → Season → **Start All Swiss** for everything at once.

14. Managing Each Swiss Round

Who Does What	Action
Players	Find their match in My Portal, get lobby info, play, report
You (if dispute)	Bracket tab → Resolve → review recordings → pick winner
You (round advance)	Click Next Round when it lights up gold
After Round 7	Click Cut to Top 8

15. Resolving Disputes

- 1 Go to the Bracket tab — disputed matches are highlighted in red.
- 2 Click Resolve, ask both players for their recording.
- 3 Pick the correct winner. Result is confirmed.

No recording = dispute goes against that player. Make this clear in your tournament rules.

16. Running the Top 8 Playoff

Match	Seeding
Quarterfinal 1	1st seed vs 8th seed
Quarterfinal 2	4th seed vs 5th seed
Quarterfinal 3	2nd seed vs 7th seed
Quarterfinal 4	3rd seed vs 6th seed

17. Exporting to Discord

Go to the **Discord** tab for ready-to-paste content — announcement, and per-division bracket exports.

- 1 Click Copy, paste into your channel, press Enter.

18. Managing Players (Ban, Reports)

Banning: Admin → Players → click Ban next to the player.

Reports: Admin → Reports → review reason, click Ban Player or Mark Resolved.

19. Your Hosting Bonus (Kickback)

The platform organiser may share a percentage of their admin fee back with you, as a thank-you for running an active community.

If a kickback % has been set for your tournament, you'll see a '■ **Your Hosting Bonus**' card on your Admin → Season page showing:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | The percentage rate the organiser is sharing with you |
| 2 | Amount earned so far |
| 3 | Amount paid to you so far |
| 4 | Amount still owed to you |

The organiser sends this directly to your PayPal email on file (the same one you use to receive prize fees) as players' admin fee payments are confirmed. This is tracked for transparency but the actual payment is sent manually by the organiser.

20. Your Responsibilities for Prize Distribution

Item	Your Responsibility
Receiving prize fees	Players pay your PayPal email directly per division. Confirm in Admin → Payments.
Prize pool total	Shown live per division in Admin → Tiers
Prize split	Set once per division in Admin → Tiers
Winner determination	The app crowns a champion per division — you look up 2nd/3rd from standings
Distribution	Your choice — PayPal, e-Transfer, gift cards, etc.

21. Backup & Data

- 1 Admin → Data → Export Backup downloads a JSON file
- 2 Restore Backup to load it back in

22. Quick Reference — Admin Checklist

Before Tournament Starts:

Task	Location	Done?
Change admin password	Admin → Passwords	[]
Set season + PayPal email, Save	Admin → Season	[]
Set per-division fees + splits, Save	Admin → Tiers	[]
Set time windows, Save	Admin → Time Windows	[]
Set placement settings, Save	Admin → Placement	[]
Post Discord announcement	Discord tab	[]
Open registration	Admin → Season	[]

During Tournament:

Task	Frequency
Confirm payments received	As players submit
Close registration & generate schedule	Once
Open division brackets	Once
Lock settings, Start Swiss	Once per division
Click Next Round	Once per round (×7)
Resolve disputes	As needed
Export backup	Before/after each weekend

After Tournament Ends:

Task	Location
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Distribute prizes per division	Final standings + prize split %
Reset all payments for next season	Admin → Season → Reset All Payments